

Develop Your Job Search Story

You have the opportunity to positively position yourself in the minds of listeners every time you tell a part of your professional story. What should be included? How should it be conveyed?

Components of your job search story will be woven into your networking conversations, LinkedIn profile, cover letters, and interviews. Thus, *your message is not a memorized statement about yourself, but rather a group of points that you can use to support your candidacy.*

Answering the bulleted questions below will help you build the components of your story so you can practice it in a variety of formats. Develop several well-crafted points and selectively choose how to weave them into your communication.

- **Who are you?** Include your name and school, if appropriate.
- **What is your career focus?** What industry and function are you targeting?
- **Why are you targeting this line of work?** Explaining your motivations may tie your story together.
- **What do you currently do professionally?** If you aren't currently employed, what *did* you do?
- **What about your prior experience suggests reasons for targeting your intended career?**

- **What environments do you thrive in, and how do those match this career?**

- **How has your work history prepared you for success going forward?** What benefits can employers derive from your skills based on your proven accomplishments?

- **In what ways do you excel as a(n):**
 - o **Individual contributor?** (Provide an example)

 - o **Team player?** (Provide an example)

 - o **Leader?** (Provide an example)

- **What attributes differentiate you from other candidates?** What are your unique selling points?

- **What else would you like to convey about yourself?**

- **What negative impressions or stereotypes might you have to overcome?** What could you say to address them, if appropriate?